



NABARD Grade A

Comprehensive Guide Book

Start Your Journey Here

Preface

This comprehensive guide is your go-to resource for understanding, preparing, and excelling in the NABARD Grade A examination. Designed by experienced mentors, this guide brings together everything you need from syllabus, exam pattern, eligibility, and resources to previous cut-offs, job profile, salary, perks, and much more.

Without such clarity, aspirants often find themselves confused about the exact structure of the exam, its phases, subjects, and marking scheme. This confusion can lead to an unfocused preparation strategy, wasted time, and unreliable information from scattered sources. Having all accurate and updated details in one place will help you prepare in the right direction with confidence.

This guidebook covers everything you must know about NABARD and the Grade A exam, including:

- Exam notifications and historic data
- Job profile, roles, perks, and career growth
- Eligibility, pattern, and syllabus
- Cut-off trend and exam analysis
- Resources for every subject and interview
- Study plan & Tips

By exploring these sections in detail, this guide will help you gain a complete understanding of the exam as well as life as a NABARD Grade A officer — from preparation to posting.

Whether you're a first-time aspirant or someone improving your strategy, this guide will serve as your trusted roadmap to success.

Wishing you the very best in your journey to becoming a NABARD Grade A officer.



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Part 1

NABARD Grade A

Notification

Nabard Grade A Exam Notification

Understanding the timeline of notifications, vacancies, and exam dates is essential for effective preparation.

1.1 Notification Years and Dates

Here is a quick reference of the **last 4 recruitment cycles**, covering the release date of notification, Phase 1 & 2 exam dates, and their result dates.

NABARD Grade A Notification Timeline (2021–2025)						
Year	Notification Release	Phase 1 Exam	Phase 1 Result	Phase 2 Exam	Phase 2 Result	Final Result
2021 - 22	17 Jul 2021	17 Sep 2021	15 Oct 2021	16 Nov 2021	31 Dec 2021	22 Apr 2022
2022 - 23	18 Jul 2022	7 Sep 2022	3 Oct 2022	29 Oct 2022	2 Dec 2022	19 Apr 2023
2023 - 24	2 Sep 2023	16 Oct 2023	4 Nov 2023	19 Nov 2023	22 Dec 2023	21 Feb 2024
2024 - 25	27 Jul 2024	1 Sep 2024	27 Sep 2024	20 Oct 2024	29 Nov 2024	24 Feb 2025
2025 - 26	8 Nov 2025	20 Dec 2025	To be announced	25 Jan 2026	To be announced	To be announced

Key Takeaways

- The gap between the notification and the Phase 1 exam is usually between **36 - 62 days**. The average gap across the years (2021–2024) is about **48 days**.
- The Phase 1 result usually comes out in **19 - 28 days**, with an average of about **25 days**.
- The gap between Phase 1 and Phase 2 is around **34 - 60 days**, which gives candidates roughly **7 weeks** on average.
- The Phase 2 result is declared in **33 - 45 days**, with an average of about **38 days**.
- The final result takes the longest. It comes **61 - 138 days** after the Phase 2 result, with an average of about **100 days**.

1.2 Number of Vacancies

The number of vacancies has shown fluctuations in recent years:

NABARD Grade A - General Stream Number of Vacancies & Applications					
Year	Vacancies	Total Applications Received	Total Appeared Applicants - Phase 1	Total Students Cleared Phase 1	Total Appeared Applicants - Phase 2
2021 - 22	74	71589	39994	4858	2865
2022 - 23	80	60806	35538	3086	2775
2023 - 24	77	74042	45113	3196	2876
2024 - 25	50	52920	35243	1340	1266
2025 - 26	77	To be announced	To be announced	To be announced	To be announced

1.3 Key Takeaways

- The highest **General Stream** vacancies were **80 in 2022–23**.
- The lowest **General Stream** vacancies were **40 in 2025–26**.
- General Stream vacancies decreased by **50%** from 80 (2022–23) to 40 (2025–26).
- Total vacancies across all streams were **161 (2022), 150 (2023), 102 (2024), and 135 (2025)**.
- Applications decreased from **71,589 in 2021–22** to **52,920 in 2024–25**, which is a **26% drop**

Phase 1 Attendance:

- **2021–22:** 39,994 out of 71,589 appeared for Phase 1 → **56% attendance**
- **2022–23:** 35,538 out of 60,806 appeared for Phase 1 → **58% attendance**
- **2023–24:** 45,113 out of 74,042 appeared for Phase 1 → **61% attendance**
- **2024–25:** 35,243 out of 52,920 appeared for Phase 1 → **67% attendance**

This means **33 - 44% of applicants do not even appear** for the Phase 1 exam.

Phase 2 Attendance:

As you can clearly see in the data, many General Stream students who clear Phase 1 do not appear for Phase 2.

- In **2021–22**, **4,858** students cleared Phase 1, but only **2,865** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **1,993 students**, which means **41% did not appear**.
- In **2022–23**, **3,086** students cleared Phase 1, but only **2,775** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **311 students**, meaning **10% did not appear**.
- In **2023–24**, **3,196** students cleared Phase 1, but only **2,876** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **320 students**, which is again **10% not appearing**.
- In **2024–25**, **1,340** students cleared Phase 1, but only **1,266** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **74 students**, meaning **6% did not appear**.

On average, **6% to 41%** of students who qualify Phase 1 do not appear for Phase 2.

This means your actual competition becomes lower at the Phase 2 stage, because a noticeable percentage of qualified candidates choose not to sit for the exam.

Overall Competition:

- Since 33 - 44% of applicants skip Phase 1 and another 6 - 41% skip Phase 2, the **real competition is much lower than the total number of applications.**

1.4 Next Notification Details / Rumours

From 2021 - 22 to 2024 - 25, the notifications for this exam have come out between **July and September every year. However, the 2025 - 26 notification broke this pattern**, as it was released in **November 2025**, which is **3 - 4 months later than usual.**

So far, the notification gap has been:

- 2021 → 2022: 1 year
- 2022 → 2023: 1 year
- 2023 → 2024: 11 months
- 2024 → 2025: 16 months

Based on this trend, the **next notification may not follow the traditional July–September window**, and candidates should stay prepared for the possibility of a **late-2026 announcement.**

EduTap

Part 2

NABARD Grade A

Job Profile, Salary & Lifestyle

NABARD Grade A Officer Job

Before preparing for the exam, every aspirant should clearly understand what the NABARD Grade A Officer job involves, the roles and responsibilities, departments they'll handle, salary, tax deductions, allowances, perks, training, postings, transfers, and promotion structure.

Knowing these details helps you stay motivated and plan your career journey with clarity.

2.1 Role/Responsibilities of NABARD Assistant Manager

As a NABARD Grade A Officer, you play an important role in supporting rural development and strengthening India's agricultural and financial systems. Your work involves handling responsibilities across multiple functions such as:

- **Preliminary Loan & Grant Scrutiny:** Reviewing and checking loan and grant applications in the initial stage.
- **Proposal Evaluation and Presentation:** Evaluating proposals submitted by agencies seeking NABARD's support, conducting due diligence, and presenting your assessment to senior management at both the Head Office and Regional Office.
- **Coordination with Institutions:** Working closely with banks, NGOs, deputy commissioners, municipalities, and state government bodies.
- **Credit Planning and Monitoring:** Taking part in planning, monitoring, and coordinating credit-related activities.
- **District-Level Credit Deployment:** Helping create a coordinated approach for credit flow and deployment within the district.

Important Note: The role and responsibilities of a NABARD Grade A officer depend on the department they are assigned to. Departments are allotted based on NABARD's requirements.

2.2 Salary & Allowances

As per the latest notification, the monthly gross emoluments for NABARD Grade A officers are around ₹1.1 lakh, which adds up to **₹13.2 lakh per annum**.

Please note that the exact in-hand salary may vary from person to person depending on location, tax regime, and the allowances actually availed.

Important Note: DA is given as % of NABARD Grade A basic pay, which keeps on varying.

2.2.1 Monthly Allowances

You are also eligible for Dearness Allowance, Local Compensatory Allowance, House Rent Allowance, and Grade Allowance as per rules in force. There are additional benefits as follows.

Employee Name: [REDACTED]

Office: [REDACTED]

Designation [REDACTED]

NABARD
Assistant Manager

Salary Slip

Statement of Salary for the Month of Aug,2025

Pay & Allowances	₹	Deductions	₹
Basic Pay	₹ 44,500.00	Prov. Fund/NPS	₹ 9,684.00
Dearness Allowance	₹ 35,018.00	Medical Premium	₹ 300.00
LCA (CCA)	₹ 2,225.00	Lounge Subs	₹ 400.00
Grade Allowance	₹ 10,400.00	Income Tax and E	₹ 7,524.00
Special Allowance	₹ 8,250.00	Profession Tax	₹ 208.00
LCA (SCA)	₹ 500.00	Association Subs	₹ 3,208.00
LCA (FA)	₹ 1,780.00	—	—
Spl Perquisite Allowance	₹ 3,701.00	—	—
SPA Cess	₹ 148.00	—	—
Learning Allowance	₹ 2,500.00	—	—
Special Grade Allowance	₹ 2,652.00	—	—
Gross Pay	₹ 1,11,674.00	Total Deductions	₹ 21,324.00

Take Home Pay: ₹ 90,350.00 (Rupees Ninety Thousand Three Hundred Fifty)***CONFIDENTIAL DETAILS HAS BEEN BLACKED OUT.**

NABARD Grade A Officer's Monthly Allowances	
Allowances	Amount (Monthly)
Fuel	₹21,000
Household	₹5,000
Internet	₹1,500
Mobile	₹1,100
Newspaper	₹800
Equipment Maintenance	₹500
HRA	₹25,000
Children Education	₹7,000
Sodexo Coupon	₹3,600
Total	₹65,500

2.2.2 Annual Allowances

NABARD Grade A Salary Annual Allowances	
Allowances	Amount (Yearly)
Book Grant	₹7,000
Medical	₹13,000
Briefcase	₹4,000
Furniture	₹55,000
Spectacles	₹9,000
LFC	₹15,000
Total	₹1,03,000

When you add up all the components, the salary package of a NABARD Grade A officer looks like this:

- **Gross salary:** Around ₹12 lakhs per year (₹1,00,000/month x 12)
- **Monthly allowances:** Approximately ₹8 lakhs per year (₹65,500/month x 12)
- **Annual allowances:** Around ₹1 lakh per year

This brings the total NABARD assistant manager CTC to approximately **₹21 lakhs per annum**, or roughly **₹1.75 lakhs per month**.

2.2.3 Salary Deductions

NABARD Grade A Salary Deduction	
Deductions	Amount
PF/NPS Contribution	₹9,000 (approx.)
Income Tax	₹12,000 (approx.)
Total	Around ₹21,000

2.2.4 In-Hand Salary

NABARD Grade A In-Hand Salary	
Component	Amount (Monthly)
Gross Salary	₹1,11,000
Salary Deduction	₹21,000 (approx)
Total	Around ₹90,000

2.3 Additional Perks & Benefits

- You can get loans at concessional interest rates (around 5.5% per year) for your child's education, housing, car purchase, or even buying a personal computer.
- NABARD reimburses medical expenses for you and your family, giving you financial relief during health-related situations.
- NABARD reimburses the cost of higher studies after you complete probation, as long as the

course matches NABARD's goals and requirements.

- You receive Group Term Insurance, which offers financial security to your family in case of an unfortunate event.
- You earn **1 ordinary leave every 11 days**, and you can accumulate it for up to **10 months**.
- You get **15 days of casual leave (CL)** in a year, and you can carry it forward for **up to 3 years**.
- You earn **1 sick leave every month**, and you can save it without any limit. You may take sick leave at half pay or take 2 days of sick leave at full pay.
- You can get **study leave**, but it is approved only after you meet certain conditions.

2.4 Training at NABARD

After selection, you attend a **2-week induction training** at the *National Bank Staff College*, located inside the **Bankers Institute of Rural Development (BIRD), Lucknow**.

During the training, you learn about the **organization's values, ethics, rules, and policies**. You also get basic orientation about NABARD so that you understand the culture and expectations before joining your posting.

The daily schedule is generally **9 AM to 6 PM**, but the exact timings may change based on the day's plan. Classes cover organizational understanding, discipline, and professional conduct. You also get time to interact with other newly inducted officers.

You stay on the BIRD campus in **individual accommodation**, and NABARD provides your **breakfast, lunch, and dinner**. You also receive a starter kit that includes a bag, notebook, and pen.

After 2 weeks, when the training is about to end, you receive your **posting location**, and you later get your specific department once you join your office.

You receive your **full salary from the first day of joining**, with **no deduction** during the training period.

2.5 Postings

Here is the posting policy of a NABARD Grade A officer:

- NABARD's central office is in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- In addition to its headquarters, NABARD has around 30 regional offices in urban locations across the country.
- As a NABARD Grade A officer, you're likely to be posted at the head office (Mumbai) or any of the regional offices in tier-1 or tier-2 cities, mostly confined to the state capitals. So, you can contribute to rural and agricultural development while still enjoying the perks of city life.

Note: NABARD Grade A officers can be posted anywhere across the country but in their home state.

2.6 Transfers

Here are some key points about the transfer policy of NABARD Grade A officers:

- NABARD Grade A officers are usually transferred to different locations every 3-5 years based on operational requirements.
- These transfers can involve switching departments, regional offices, or job functions.
- The duration of each transfer varies from several months to several years, depending on specific needs.

2.7 Promotions

The future career growth for an NABARD Grade A officer is quite promising, with many promotion opportunities.

Important Note: The timeframe mentioned is the minimum eligibility requirement for NABARD Grade A promotion. Advancement to higher positions also depends on the availability of vacancies within NABARD.

Here's a breakdown of the promotions that lie ahead for NABARD Grade A officers:

NABARD Grade A Promotions



Part 3

NABARD Grade A

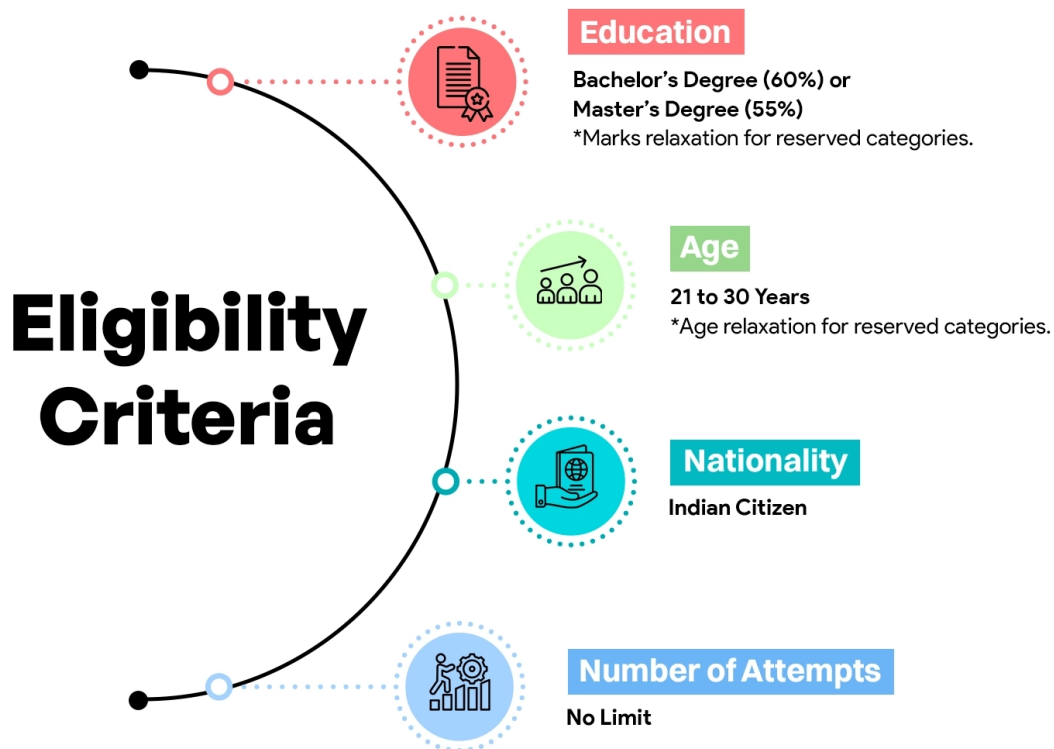
Eligibility

Eligibility

The eligibility criteria for NABARD Grade A specifies the minimum educational qualifications, age limits, and requirements that candidates must meet.

While the official notification outlines these conditions in detail, we have summarised them clearly to help you quickly understand whether you qualify for the exam.

NABARD GRADE A



3.1 Age Limit & Relaxation

- The age for the NABARD Grade A exam is calculated as of the date mentioned in the respective year's official notification.
- The minimum age limit for the NABARD Grade A officer (Unreserved/General category) is **21 years**.
- The maximum age limit for the unreserved/general category is 30 years, with the eligible date of birth clearly specified in that year's notification.

For reserved categories, the details are given below:

NABARD GRADE A

Maximum Age Limit and Relaxation

Category	Age Relaxation	Upper Age Limit
General	None	30
OBC	3 Years	33
SC/ST	5 Years	35
Ex-Servicemen	5 Years	35
1984 Riots Victims' Children	5 Years	35
PwBD (General/EWS)	10 Years	40
PwBD (OBC)	13 Years	43
PwBD (SC/ST)	15 Years	45

3.2 Educational Qualification (General Stream)

- You must have the required educational qualification as of 1st of the month in which the notification for the NABARD Grade A Assistant Manager recruitment is released.
- Bachelor's Degree in any subject from a recognized University with a minimum of 60% marks (SC/ST/PWBD applicants – 55%) in aggregate.
- Post Graduate degree, MBA/PGDM with a minimum of 55% marks (SC/ST/PWBD applicants – 50%) in aggregate
- CA/ CS/ICWA OR Ph.D. from Institutions recognized by GOI/UGC SC/ST/PWBD applicants)

NABARD GRADE A Eligibility Educational Qualifications

Bachelor's degree in any
subject with a minimum of 60% marks
(55% for SC/ST/PwBD applicants)

Master's degree in MBA/PGDM with a
minimum of 55% marks
(50% marks for SC/ST/PwBD applicants)

CA/CS/ICWA

Ph.D

3.3 Nationality

According to the latest official NABARD Grade A assistant manager notification, only Indian citizens can apply for the exam.

3.4 Number of Attempts

The official notification for the NABARD Grade A examination **did not specify a maximum number of attempts**. As long as you meet all the eligibility criteria, you can apply for the NABARD Grade A Assistant Manager (RDBS) exam.

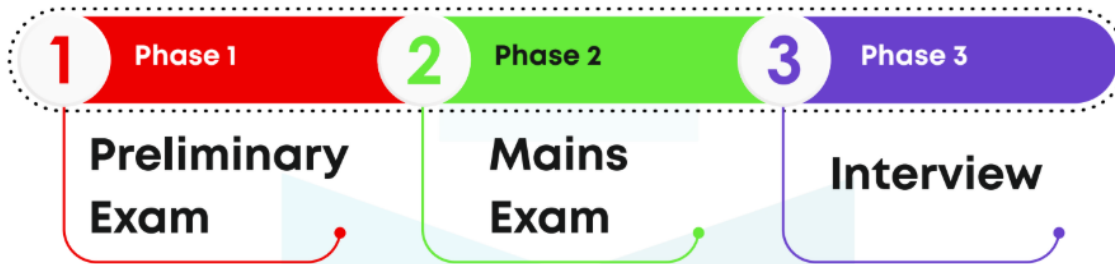
Part 4

NABARD Grade A

Exam Pattern

Pattern

Officers in Grade A cadre of the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) are



4.1 NABARD Grade A Phase 1 Pattern

The NABARD Grade A Phase 1 includes both **non-merit (qualifying)** sections and **merit** sections. Marks from this stage are used only to shortlist candidates for Phase 2 and are **not counted** in the final merit list.

Candidates must clear the **sectional cut-off** for all subjects, and must also clear the **overall cut-off** based on the marks scored in the merit sections.

4.1.1 Phase 1 Pattern Details

- It consists of **one objective-type paper** covering 8 subjects:
 - **Non-Merit (Qualifying) Sections**
 - Reasoning Ability
 - English
 - Computer Knowledge
 - Quantitative Aptitude
 - Decision Making
 - For the non-merit subjects, you need to clear the minimum cut-off for every subject.
 - **Merit Sections**
 - General Awareness
 - Economic and Social Issues
 - Agriculture and Rural Development
 - For the merit subjects, in addition to clearing the minimum cut-off for every subject, the total marks you score in these subjects must be more than the overall cut-off.
 - Below is the distribution of questions and marks across all subjects:

NABARD Grade A Phase 1 Pattern		
Section	Questions	Marks
Non-Merit / Qualifying Sections		
Reasoning	20	20
English	30	30
Computer Knowledge	20	20
Quantitative Aptitude	20	20
Decision Making	10	10
Merit Sections		
General Awareness	20	20
Economic & Social Issues	40	40
Agriculture & Rural Development	40	40
Total	200	200

Candidates get **120 minutes** to attempt all questions. There is **no section-wise time limit**.

- The exam is conducted **online** and consists of **objective MCQs**.
- The paper is available in **Hindi and English**, except the English Language section (available only in English).
- **Negative marking** applies: **0.25 marks** are deducted for every wrong answer.
- Both sectional and overall cut-offs are decided as per the **calling ratio** for Phase 2.
- The total duration of the exam is **2 hours**.

NABARD Grade A Phase 1 Additional Details	
Detail	Information
Mode	Online
Paper Structure	Objective-Type (MCQs)
Nature	Qualifying
Language	Hindi & English (except English Language section)
Total Questions	200
Total Marks	200
Overall Cut-Off	As per the calling ratio
Sectional Cut-Off	As per the calling ratio
Negative Marking	0.25
Duration	2 hours
Sectional Timing	No

4.2 NABARD Grade A Phase 2 Pattern

The Phase 2 (Mains) examination consists of **2 papers**.

Both papers are counted for the final merit list. The total marks for Phase 2 are **200**, and the exam includes both **objective** and **descriptive** questions.

4.2.1 Paper 1 – General English

Paper 1 is a **descriptive English** test conducted online.

- You must type your answers on the computer.
- Contains **3 descriptive questions**
- Carries **100 marks**
- Must be completed in **90 minutes**
- Tests your writing skills through essay, précis, and comprehension-type questions

4.2.2 Paper 2 – Economic & Social Issues + Agriculture & Rural Development

Paper 2 contains both **objective** and **descriptive** components.

- It consists of **30 objective MCQs**.
- **6 descriptive questions**, out of which **4 must be attempted**
- Carries **100 marks**
- Must be completed in **120 minutes**
 - 30 minutes for objective section
 - 90 minutes for descriptive section

NABARD Grade A Phase 2 Pattern	
Detail	Information
Mode	Online
Paper Structure	MCQs + Descriptive
Languages	Hindi & English (English paper only in English)
Total Questions	39 (attempt 37)
Total Marks	200
Negative Marking	0.25 for 1-mark questions, 0.50 for 2-mark questions
Cut-Off	Based on calling ratio

Phase 2 marks are counted in the **final selection**.

4.3 NABARD Grade A – Phase 3 (Interview) Pattern

Candidates who clear Phase 2 must first complete a **psychometric test**, followed by an in-person interview.

The interview carries **50 marks** and is added to Phase 2 for the final merit list.

4.3.1 Psychometric Test

- **Mode:** Online (can be taken from home)
- **Language:** English or any of 9 Indian languages
- **Questions:** Around **100–120** personality and behavior-based questions
- **Marks:** No marks are allotted

- **Duration:** Usually **15–20 minutes**, but there is **no fixed time limit**
- The system records your completion time as part of your profile report

4.3.2 Interview

- **Mode:** In person at designated centers
- **Language:** Hindi or English
- **Questions:** Varies by panel
- **Marks: 50 marks**
- **Duration:** Typically **20–45 minutes**

Final selection is based on the **combined score** of:

- Phase 2 (Paper 1 + Paper 2)
- Interview (50 marks)

Only candidates who score well in both stages are selected as **NABARD Grade A Officers**.

4.4 Changes in the NABARD Grade A Exam Pattern

Over the years, NABARD has made several updates to the Phase 1, Phase 2, and Interview stages. Below is a clear breakdown of these changes.

4.4.1 Changes in Phase 1 (Prelims)

The last major update to the Phase 1 pattern was introduced in **2021**.

Before 2021

- Phase 1 had **7 subjects**: Quantitative Aptitude (20), Reasoning (20), English (40), Computer Knowledge (20), General Awareness (20), ESI (40), ARD (40).
- The **English** section carried **40 marks**.
- There was **no division** between merit and non-merit sections.
- The paper had **200 questions for 200 marks**.
- The **overall cut-off** was calculated **out of 200 marks**.

From 2021 Onwards

- The weightage of **English** reduced from **40 marks to 30 marks**.
- A new subject, **Decision Making (10 marks)**, was added.
- The total number of subjects increased to **8**: Reasoning, English, Computer Knowledge, Quantitative Aptitude, Decision Making, General Awareness, ESI, ARD.
- Subjects were divided into **Merit** and **Non-Merit** categories.
- The **overall cut-off** is now calculated **out of 100 marks** (based on ESI, ARD, and GA only).

4.4.2 Changes in Phase 2 (Mains)

A key modification was introduced in **2021**.

- Before 2021, Paper 2 (ESI & ARD) contained **only objective questions**.
- **From 2021 onwards, Paper 2** now includes **both objective (50%) and descriptive (50%) questions**.

4.4.3 Changes in the Interview (Phase 3)

The Interview stage has seen two major updates.

- **Till 2021**, the interview carried **25 marks**.
- **In 2021**, Interview marks were increased to **50**.
- **In 2023**, A **psychometric test** was introduced before the interview.

Part 5

NABARD Grade A

Syllabus

Syllabus

The NABARD Grade A syllabus is structured across **Phase 1, Phase 2, and the Interview**. While the official notification provides a broad, indicative list of topics, it can feel **too general for focused preparation**.

To help aspirants, we have **carefully collated a detailed syllabus by thoroughly analyzing previous years' question papers**, ensuring you know exactly what to prepare for each phase.

5.1 Reasoning

- Alphanumeric Series
- Coding and Decoding
- Syllogism
- Direction Sense
- Inequality
- Ranking and Order
- Blood Relation
- Puzzles
- Seating Arrangement
- Input-Output
- Critical Reasoning
- Questions Based on Data Sufficiency
- Questions based on Statements

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of Reasoning



MOST IMPORTANT

- Alphanumeric Series
- Coding and Decoding
- Syllogism
- Inequality
- Direction Sense
- Blood Relation
- Ranking and Order



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Seating Arrangement
- Puzzles
- Data Sufficiency



LEAST IMPORTANT

- Statement Assumption
- Statement Argument
- Statement Conclusion
- Statement Cause and Effect
- Statement Course of Action
- Machine Input Output

5.2 Quantitative Aptitude

- Ratio and Proportion
- Percentage
- Profit and Loss
- Simple and Compound Interest
- Average and Ages
- Time and Work
- Pipes and Cistern
- Time and Distance
- Mixture and Alligation
- Series and Quadratic Equation
- Mathematical Inequalities
- Number Series

- Data Interpretation
- Simplification/Approximation
- Quantity Comparisons

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of Quant



MOST IMPORTANT

- Number Series
- Quadratic Equation
- Percentage
- Ratio and Proportion
- Data Interpretation
- Partnership
- Ages



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Profit and Loss
- Simple Interest
- Compound Interest
- Time and Work
- Pipes and Cistern
- Time Speed and Distance
- Boats and Stream
- Allegation and Mixture



LEAST IMPORTANT

- Average
- Permutation and Combination
- Probability
- Mensuration 2D
- Mensuration 3D

5.3 English

- Reading Comprehension
- Sentence Rearrangement
- Cloze Test
- Para jumbles
- Double fillers
- Error Detection and Sentence Improvement
- Vocabulary (Synonyms, Antonyms, One-word Substitution, Phrasal verbs)

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of English



MOST IMPORTANT

- Subject - Verb Agreement
- Tenses
- Prepositions
- Complex Prepositions
- Reading Comprehension
- Cloze-Test
- Rearrangement



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Pronoun
- Conditional Sentences
- Adjectives
- Adverbs
- Conjunctions
- Para Jumbles
- Synonyms
- Antonyms
- Phrasal Verbs
- Idioms & Phrases



LEAST IMPORTANT

- Modals
- Articles
- Active Passive Voice
- One word Substitution

5.4 Computer Knowledge

- Computer Awareness
- Hardware and Memory
- Software and Operating Systems
- MS Office
- Database Management System
- Internet and Computer Security
- History and Computer & Generations
- Shortcuts

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of Computer Knowledge



MOST IMPORTANT

- Computer Software
- Operating System
- MS Office
- Data Communication and Computer Network
- Internet and Computer Security



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- History and Computer & Generations
- Emerging Trend
- Memory Organization
- Computer Hardware
- Computer Organization and Data Processing



LEAST IMPORTANT

- Number System Articles
- Database Management System

5.5 Decision Making

- Basics of Decision Making
- Types of Decision Making
- Decision Making Models
- Decision Making Approaches
- Factors Affecting Decision Making
- Types of Problems Decision Making

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of Decision making

★★★★★

MOST IMPORTANT
.....

- Basics of Decision Making
- Decision Making Process
- Types of Decision Making
- Decision Making Models
- Techniques of Decision Making
- Biasness in Decision-Making

★★★

MODERATELY IMPORTANT
.....

- Conditions of Decision-Making
- Decision-Making Styles
- Miscellaneous topics (Related to basics of General Management)

★★

LEAST IMPORTANT
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- Decision Support System and Management Information System

5.6 General Awareness

- Current affairs of the preceding 6 months from the date of examination
- National News: MoUs, summits, and major events related to India.
- International: Summits and conferences held abroad
- Defence: Military exercises, drills, and major updates related to the defence sector of India
- Days in News: Major events or days, along with its date, and theme
- Persons in News: Obituaries, appointments, retirements
- Sports: Major tournaments and their winners
- Science, Technology, and Space
- Awards and honours
- Environment
- Banking, Economy, and Schemes
- Books and Authors

- Static GA: Chief Ministers and Cabinet Ministers, National Parks and Sanctuaries, Organizations' Headquarters, Banks' Headquarters, Taglines, Power Plants in India, Indian Dance Forms, Countries' Capitals and their Currencies

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of GA

★★★★★ MOST IMPORTANT	★★★ MODERATELY IMPORTANT	★★ LEAST IMPORTANT
• Government Schemes • Finance Current Affairs • ESI/ARD Current Affairs • Government Initiatives • Banking and Finance Static • Sports • First in News • Science and Technology • Days in News	• Appointments • Persons in News • MOUs • Agreements	• Places in News • Fairs and Festivals

*For Static GA, here are the important topics: Chief Ministers and Cabinet Ministers, National Parks and Sanctuaries, Organization's Headquarters, Bank's Headquarters and Taglines, Power Plants in India, Indian Dance Forms, Countries' Capitals and their currencies

5.7 Economic and Social Issues (ESI)

Following is the syllabus given in the NABARD Grade A notification for Phase 1 and 2.

- **Nature of Indian Economy**
 - Structural and Institutional features
 - Economic underdevelopment
 - Opening the Indian Economy
 - Globalisation
 - Economic Reforms in India
 - Privatisation

- Inflation
- Trends in Inflation & their Impact on National Economy and Individual Income.
- **Poverty Alleviation and Employment Generation in India**
 - Rural and Urban
 - Measurement of Poverty
 - Poverty Alleviation Programmes of the Government.
- **Population Trends**
 - Population Growth and Economic Development
 - Population Policy in India
- **Agriculture**
 - Characteristics / Status
 - Technical and Institutional changes in Indian Agriculture
 - Agricultural performance
 - Issues in Food Security in India
 - Non-Institutional and Institutional Agencies in rural credit
- **Industry**
 - Industrial and Labour Policy
 - Industrial performance
 - Regional Imbalance in India's Industrial Development
 - Public Sector Enterprises.
- **Rural banking and financial institutions in India**
 - Reforms in Banking/ Financial sector.
- **Globalization of Economy**
 - Role of International Funding Institutions
 - IMF & World Bank
 - WTO
 - Regional Economic Co-operation.
- **Social Structure in India**
 - Multiculturalism
 - Demographic trends
 - Urbanisation and Migration
 - Gender Issues Joint family system
 - Social Infrastructure

- Education
- Health and Environment
- Education
- Status & System of Education
- Socio – Economic Problems associated with Illiteracy
- Educational relevance and educational wastage
- Educational Policy for India.
- **Social Justice**
 - Problems of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes
 - Socio-economic programmes for scheduled castes and scheduled tribes and other backward classes.
- **Positive Discrimination in favour of the under privileged**
 - Social Movements
 - Indian Political Systems
 - Human Development.
- **Current Economic & Social Issues**



NABARD Grade A

Important Topics of ESI Static



MOST IMPORTANT

- Growth and Development
- Inflation
- Opening up of the Indian Economy, Balance of Payments
- Indian Political System
- Economic History of India
- International Economic Institutions



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Population and Demographic Trends
- Social Sectors In India, Health and Education
- Social Justice Positive Discrimination of Privileged
- Indian Agriculture
- Poverty Alleviation and Employment Generation In India
- Rural banking and financial institutions In India
- Regional Economic Cooperation



LEAST IMPORTANT

- Multiculturalism
- Social Movements
- Human Development
- Industry – Industrial and Labour Policy

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of ESI Current Affairs



MOST IMPORTANT

.....

Government Schemes related to the Syllabus include MGNREGA and NRLM, Ministries like the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Health, Ministry of Education, Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Fisheries, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Ministry of Social Justice etc

ESI Current Affairs topics like Social Sectors Health, Social Sectors - Education, Social Justice, Sustainable Development and Environmental Issues, Regional Economic Co-operation, International Economic Institutes, Indian Agriculture and Indian Political System

Reports like National Education Policy, National Curriculum Framework, Census



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

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Reports: Released by National, International, and Private Organizations related to syllabus other than those mentioned above, like reports released by WTO, IMF, Niti Aayog, FICCI, WHO, etc. For example, the World Malaria Report - WHO, Women Business and Law Index - World Bank, etc

ESI Current Affairs topics include Measurement of Growth, Inflation, Industrial Development, and Globalization



LEAST IMPORTANT

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Government Schemes related to the Ministry of Culture, Ministry of Defence, etc

Reports like the SRS Statistical Report

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5.8 Agriculture and Rural Development

The NABARD Grade A notification has the following syllabus for Phase 2 of the exam. It is applicable for Phase 1 also, as the ARD syllabus for both Phases is the same.

- **Agriculture: Crop Production & Agro-Climatic Zones**
 - Definition, meaning and its branches, Agronomy: definition, meaning and scope of agronomy. Classification of field crops. Factors affecting crop production, Agro-Climatic Zones; Cropping Systems: Definition and types of cropping systems. Problems of dry land agriculture; Seed production, seed processing, seed village; Meteorology: weather parameters, crop-weather advisory; Precision Farming, System of Crop Intensification, organic farming;
- **Soil and Water Conservation: Erosion Control & Watershed Management**
 - Major soil types, soil fertility, fertilisers, soil erosion, soil conservation, watershed management;
- **Water Resource Management: Irrigation Types & Techniques**
 - Irrigation Management: types of irrigation, sources of irrigation, crop-water requirement, command area development, water conservation techniques, micro-irrigation, irrigation pumps, major, medium, and minor irrigation.
- **Farm Engineering: Machinery, Storage & Processing**
 - Farm Machinery and Power, Sources of power on the farm- human, animal, mechanical, electrical, wind, solar and biomass, bio fuels, water harvesting structures, farm ponds, watershed management, Agro Processing, Controlled, and modified storage, perishable food storage, godowns, bins, and grain silos.
- **Horticulture: Post-Harvest Tech & Value Chain**
 - Definition, meaning and its branches. Agronomic practices and production technology of various plantation and horticulture crops. Post-harvest management, value and supply chain management of Plantation and Horticulture crops.
- **Animal Husbandry: Breeds, Dairy & Poultry Trends**
 - Farm animals and their role in Indian economy, Animal husbandry methods in India, common terms pertaining to different species of livestock, Utility classification of breeds of cattle. Introduction to common feeds and fodders, their classification, and utility. Introduction to the poultry industry in India (past, present, and future status), Common terms pertaining to poultry production and management. Concept of mixed farming and its relevance to socio-economic conditions of farmers in India. Complementary and obligatory nature of livestock and poultry production with that of agricultural farming.
- **Fisheries: Aquaculture & Marine Resources**
 - Fisheries resources, management, and exploitation – freshwater, brackish water, and marine; Aquaculture- Inland and marine; biotechnology; post-harvest technology. Importance of fisheries in India. Common terms pertaining to fish production.

- **Forestry: Social Forestry & Climate Initiatives**

- Basic concepts of Forest and Forestry. Principles of silviculture, forest mensuration, forest management, and forest economics. Concepts of social forestry, agroforestry, joint forest management. Forest policy and legislation in India, India State of Forest Report 2015. Recent developments under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

- **Agriculture Extensions: KVKs & Tech Dissemination**

- Its importance and role, methods of evaluation of extension programs, and Role of Krishi Vigyan Kendra's (KVK) in the dissemination of Agricultural technologies.

- **Climate Change: GHG, Carbon Credits & Policies**

- Ecology and its relevance to man, natural resources, their sustainable management and conservation. Causes of climate change, Green House Gases (GHG), major GHG emitting countries, climate analysis, distinguishing between adaptation and mitigation, climate change impact to agriculture and rural livelihood, carbon credit, IPCC, UNFCCC, CoP meetings, funding mechanisms for climate change projects, initiatives by Govt of India, NAPCC, SAPCC, INDC.

- **Present Scenario of Indian Agriculture and Allied Activities**

- Recent trends, major challenges in agriculture measures to enhance viability of agriculture. Factors of Production in agriculture; Agricultural Finance and Marketing; Impact of Globalization on Indian Agriculture and issues of Food Security; Concept and Types of Farm Management.

- **Rural Development: Panchayati Raj & MGNREGA**

- Concept of Rural Area, Structure of the Indian Rural Economy- Importance, and role of the rural sector in India- Economic, Social and Demographic Characteristics of the Indian rural economy, causes of Rural Backwardness.
- Rural population in India; Occupational structure, Farmers, Agricultural Labourers, Artisans, Handicrafts, Traders, Forest dwellers/tribes and others in rural India- Trends of change in rural population and rural work force; problems and conditions of rural labour; Issues and challenges in Handlooms
- Panchayati Raj Institutions – Functions and Working. MGNREGA, NRLM – Aajeevika, Rural Drinking Water Programmes, Swachh Bharat, Rural Housing, PURA, and other rural development programmes.

NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of ARD Current Affairs



MOST IMPORTANT

Government Schemes related to the Syllabus include Schemes like MGNREG A and NRLM, and Ministries like the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Health, Ministry of Education, Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Fisheries, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Ministry of Social Justice, etc

Reports: Census 2011, Agri Census, Livestock Census, NABARD Annual Report, Reports Released by NABARD, MSP, Advanced Estimates, etc



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

Agriculture Reports: Reports released by ministries related to agriculture, such as the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Fisheries, Ministry of Agriculture, etc



LEAST IMPORTANT

Agriculture Current Affairs related to the syllabus

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NABARD Grade A



Important Topics of ARD Current Affairs



MOST IMPORTANT

.....

Government Schemes related to the Syllabus include Schemes like MGNREG A and NRLM, and Ministries like the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Health, Ministry of Education, Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Fisheries, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Ministry of Social Justice, etc

Reports: Census 2011, Agri Census, Livestock Census, NABARD Annual Report, Reports Released by NABARD, MSP, Advanced Estimates, etc



MODERATELY IMPORTANT

.....

Agriculture Reports: Reports released by ministries related to agriculture, such as the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Fisheries, Ministry of Agriculture, etc



LEAST IMPORTANT

.....

Agriculture Current Affairs related to the syllabus

5.9 Descriptive English

- Essay
- Précis writing
- Comprehension
- Business/Office Correspondence

Part 6

NABARD Grade A

Cut Off Marks &

Analysis

Cut Off Marks

Knowing the NABARD Grade A cut-off marks for each stage over the last few exams helps you understand the competition and set clear score targets for every phase.

Below, you'll find the year-wise cut-off marks for Phase 1 and Phase 2, and the final cut-off, along with a trend analysis to help you plan your preparation.

6.1 NABARD Grade A 2021 Cut Off

Below is the mentioned the official overall cut-off of the NABARD assistant manager 2021 exam for Phase 1, Phase 2, and final selection as a NABARD officer.

6.1.1 NABARD Grade A 2021 Phase 1 Cut Off

Here are the sectional and overall category-wise Phase 1 (prelims) cut-off marks of the NABARD Assistant Manager 2021 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2021 Phase 1 Cut-Off Marks						
Subject	General /UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Qualifying Section						
Reasoning (20)	3.75	3.75	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
English (30)	11.25	11.25	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.50
Computer Knowledge (20)	3.25	3.25	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00
Quantitative Aptitude (20)	5.00	5.00	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
Decision Making (10)	1.25	1.25	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Merit Section						
General Awareness (20)	3.00	3.00	1.75	1.75	1.75	1.75
Economic and Social Issues (40)	4.50	4.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Agriculture and Rural Development (40)	6.50	6.50	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
Total (100)	53.50	32.75	45.75	44.00	41.50	VI: 14.25 HI: 37.50 LD: 38.75 MD: 12.75

6.1.2 NABARD Grade A 2021 Phase 2 Cut Off

Here are the category-wise Phase 2 (mains) cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2021 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2021 Phase 2 Cut-Off Marks						
Subjects	General/ UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
General English (100)	50.25	50.25	48.50	48.50	48.50	48.50
ESI & ARD Objective (50)	18.75	18.75	16.00	16.00	16.00	16.00
ESI & ARD Descriptive (50)	21.25	21.25	19.00	19.00	19.00	19.00
Total (200)	118.42	115.50	114.08	109.67	109.83	VI: 93.92 HI: 106.00 LD: 114.17 MD: #

No candidate qualified.

6.1.3 NABARD Assistant Manager 2021 Final Cut-Off

Here are the category-wise final cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2021 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2021 Final Cut Off Marks						
	General/ UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Aggregate marks in Phase 2 and Interview (250 marks)	164.33	159.75	160.17HI: 141.50	152.92	157.83	VI: – HI: – LD: 147.75 MD: –

6.2 NABARD Grade A 2022 Cut Off

Below is the mentioned the official overall cut off of the NABARD assistant manager 2022 exam for Phase 1, Phase 2, and final selection as a NABARD officer.

6.2.1 NABARD Grade A 2022 Phase 1 Cut Off

Here are the sectional and overall category-wise Phase 1 (prelims) cut-off marks of the NABARD Assistant Manager 2022 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2022 Phase 1 Cut Off Marks						
Subject	General / UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Qualifying Section						
Reasoning (20)	3.75	3.75	1.50	1.50	1.50	1.50
English (30)	12.50	12.50	9.25	9.25	9.25	9.25
Computer Knowledge (20)	5.50	5.50	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00
Quantitative Aptitude (20)	3.00	3.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Decision Making (10)	1.50	1.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Merit Section						
General Awareness (20)	3.25	3.25	1.75	1.75	1.75	1.75
Economic and Social Issues (40)	2.25	2.25	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Agriculture and Rural Devel- opment (40)	6.75	6.75	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
Total (100)	41.75	29.25	37.75	33.25	30.75	VI: 9.00 HI: 10.75 LD: 24.75 MD: 10.50

6.2.2 NABARD Grade A 2022 Phase 2 Cut Off

Here are the category-wise Phase 2 (mains) cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2022 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2022 Phase 2 Cut-Off Marks						
	General/UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
General English (100)	49.00	49.00	46.25	46.25	46.25	46.25
ESI & ARD Objective (50)	19.00	19.00	15.75	15.75	15.75	15.75
ESI & ARD Descriptive (50)	23.75	23.75	20.25	20.25	20.25	20.25
Total (200)	130.50	121.50	124.50	120.00	119.25	VI: 108.50 HI: 97.25 LD: 114.00 MD: 96.00

6.2.3 NABARD Assistant Manager 2022 Final Cut Off

Here are the category-wise final cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2022 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2022 Final Cut Off Marks						
	General/ UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Aggregate marks in Phase 2 and Interview (250 marks)	171.50	165.75	167.50 VI: 147.25 HI: 135.25	160.00	156.00	VI: 156.75 HI: – LD: 156.25 MD: 141.00

6.3 NABARD Grade A 2023 Cut Off

Below is the mentioned the official overall cut off of the NABARD assistant manager 2023 exam for Phase 1, Phase 2, and final selection as a NABARD officer.

6.3.1 NABARD Grade A 2022 Phase 1 Cut Off

Here are the sectional and overall category-wise Phase 1 (prelims) cut-off marks of the NABARD Assistant Manager 2023 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2023 Phase 1 Cut Off Marks						
Subject	General /UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Qualifying Section						
Reasoning (20)	3.00	3.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
English (30)	10.25	10.25	7.00	7.00	7.00	7.00
Computer Knowledge (20)	2.75	2.75	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Quantitative Aptitude (20)	3.00	3.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Decision Making (10)	1.50	1.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Merit Section						
General Awareness (20)	2.75	2.75	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
Economic and Social Issues (40)	3.50	3.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Agriculture and Rural Development (40)	4.25	4.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
Total (100)	46.00	33.50	42.50	37.50	30.25	VI: 16.25 HI: 12.25 LD: 29.00 MD: 9.75

6.3.2 NABARD Grade A 2023 Phase 2 Cut Off

Here are the category-wise Phase 2 (mains) cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2023 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2023 Phase 2 Cut Off Marks						
	General /UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
General English (100)	53.25	53.25	51.25	51.25	51.25	51.25
ESI & ARD Objective (50)	22.50	22.50	19.50	19.50	19.50	19.50
ESI & ARD Descriptive (50)	31.00	31.00	28.00	28.00	28.00	28.00
Total (200)	128.50	121.00	125.50	120.75	111.50	VI: 98.00 HI: 99.25 LD: 115.50 MD: #

No Candidate Qualified.

6.3.3 NABARD Assistant Manager 2023 Final Cut Off

Here are the category-wise final cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2023 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2023 Final Cut Off Marks						
	General/ UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Aggregate marks in Phase 2 and Interview (250 marks)	172.75	168.50	172.75	166.00	156.75	VI: 150.25 HI: – LD: 160.50 MD: –

6.4 NABARD Grade A 2024 Cut Off

Below is the mentioned the official overall cut off of the NABARD assistant manager 2024 exam for Phase 1, Phase 2, and final selection as a NABARD officer.

6.4.1 NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 1 Cut Off

Here are the sectional and overall category-wise Phase 1 (prelims) cut-off marks of the NABARD Assistant Manager 2024 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 1 Cut Off Marks						
Subject	General /UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Qualifying Section						
Reasoning (20)	3.25	3.25	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
English (30)	10.75	10.75	7.25	7.25	7.25	7.25
Computer Knowledge (20)	4.00	4.00	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
Quantitative Aptitude (20)	4.50	4.50	2.25	2.25	2.25	2.25
Decision Making (10)	2.00	2.00	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
Merit Section						
General Awareness (20)	1.25	1.25	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Economic and Social Issues (40)	3.50	3.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Agriculture and Rural Development (40)	6.25	6.25	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
Total (100)	47.00	38.00	44.25	39.25	37.50	VI: 20.50 HI: 6.75 LD: 31.75 MD: 12.00

6.4.2 NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 2 Cut Off

Here are the category-wise Phase 2 (mains) cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2024 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 2 Cut Off Marks						
Subject	General /UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
General English (100)	54.00	54.00	51.50	51.50	51.50	51.50
ESI and ARD Objective (50)	22.25	22.25	19.25	19.25	19.25	19.25
ESI and ARD Descriptive	32.00	32.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00
Total (100)	126.75	123.00	123.50	121.00	120.25	VI: 116.50 HI: 113.75 LD: 111.75 MD: #

No Candidate Qualified.

6.4.3 NABARD Assistant Manager 2024 Final Cut Off

Here are the category-wise final cut-off marks of the NABARD assistant manager 2024 exam.

NABARD Grade A 2024 Final Cut Off Marks						
	General/ UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD (VI, HI, LD, MD)
Aggregate marks in Phase 2 and Interview (250 marks)	168.00	170.25	169.00	170.00	169.25	VI: 165.75 HI: 140.50 (No candidate qualified from LD and MD category)

6.5 Cut Off Analysis (2021–2024)

- Phase 1 cut-offs remained relatively low and stable across all years. They stayed between **41.75 and 53.50**, showing only small changes despite yearly variations in paper difficulty.
- Phase 2 cut-offs peaked in 2022 and stayed high afterwards. The Phase 2 cut-off rose from **118.42 (2021) to 130.50 (2022)**, and then remained consistently high with **128.50 (2023)** and **126.75 (2024)**.
- Final cut-offs have increased from 2021 to 2024. For example, the General category moved from **164.33 in 2021 to 168.00 in 2024**, and SC increased from **152.92 to 170.00** in the same period.
- Cut-offs were the **highest in 2023 for most categories**. General and OBC both reached **172.75**, and EWS touched **168.50**, making 2023 the peak year.
- The ST cut-off saw a big jump in 2024. It increased from **156.75 in 2023 to 169.25 in 2024**, which is a sharp rise of over **12 marks**.
- The EWS cut-off went from **159.75 (2021) → 165.75 (2022) → 168.50 (2023) → 170.25 (2024)**, showing a steady upward trend.
- PwBD cut-offs vary widely each year. For example, the VI category moved from **147.25 in 2022 to 150.25 in 2023**, and then up to **165.75 in 2024**, showing large year-to-year changes.
- General and OBC **cut-offs dropped slightly** in 2024 compared to 2023. General decreased from **172.75 in 2023 to 168.00 in 2024**, and OBC went from **172.75 to 169.00**.

NABARD Grade A Final Cut Off Comparative Analysis				
Category	2021	2022	2023	2024
Unreserved (General)	164.33	171.50	172.75	168.00
OBC	160.17	167.50	172.75	169.00
EWS	159.75	165.75	168.50	170.25
SC	152.92	160.00	166.00	170.00
ST	157.83	156.00	156.75	169.25

6.6 Key Takeaways

Aim at least 5–7 marks above the latest final cut-off for a safe margin.

2023 had the highest cut-offs; use it as your benchmark for targeted preparation.

Descriptive performance matters the most, as it heavily impacts the final score.

The final merit list depends on Phase 2 + Interview.

Practice descriptive writing regularly, since scoring variations directly affect the final cutoff.

Mock tests for both objective and descriptive papers are essential to build accuracy and time management.

Part 7

NABARD Grade A

Exam Analysis

Exam Analysis

The exam analysis section helps aspirants understand how the NABARD Grade A examination has evolved across different cycles.

By reviewing the structure of the papers, the number of questions, marking patterns, and the resulting cut-offs, aspirants can see how changes in the pattern have influenced performance trends over the years.

This analysis provides a clear view of what to expect and helps in planning a focused preparation strategy for the current cycle.

7.1 NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 1 Exam Analysis

The NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 1 (prelims) exam was held on **14 September 2024**.

This analysis will show you that the overall difficulty level of the NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 1 exam was **Moderate to Tough** difficult level.

7.1.1 Reasoning Ability

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Reasoning - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Inequality	3
Blood Relation	3
Seating Arrangement	4
Puzzle	8
Miscellaneous	2
*Each question in reasoning ability carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 Reasoning Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Inequality	3	NA	NA
Blood Relation	NA	3	NA
Seating Arrangement	NA	4	NA
Puzzle	NA	8	NA
Miscellaneous	2	NA	NA

C. Key Takeways

- The overall difficulty level of reasoning in 2024 was **moderate**, with only 4 easy questions.
- Logical Reasoning was **slightly tough** due to the increased number of puzzles.
- **No questions** were asked from topics like **sylogism** but you should not skip these.
- More than 50% of the reasoning questions come from **puzzles and seating arrangements**. So, prioritizing these topics can help you cover the majority of the reasoning syllabus.

7.1.2 Quantitative Aptitude

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Quantitative Aptitude - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Number Series	4
Approximation	4
Time & work	1
Data Interpretation	7
Profit & Loss	1
Income & Expenditure	1
Boat & Stream	1
Mixture & Allegation	1
*Each question in quant carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 Quant Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Number Series	2	2	NA
Approximation	2	2	NA
Time & work	NA	1	NA
Data Interpretation	NA	4	3
Profit & Loss	NA	1	NA
Income & Expenditure	NA	1	NA
Boat & Stream	NA	1	NA
Mixture & Allegation	NA	NA	1

C. Key Takeways

- The difficulty level of the quant section was **moderate** with only **4 easy questions**.
- The **maximum number of questions** were asked from **DI, number series, and approximation**. So, prioritize these topics in your preparation.
- DI-based questions are **time-consuming** but they come in a set of multiple questions. It is a little risky to attempt DIs but it allows you to score more marks.
- **No questions** were asked from **quadratic equations, compound interest, ages, partnership, simple interest, mensuration, and 3D**, but you should not skip these.
- Practice solving questions within a time limit to improve your speed for effective time management.
- Analyze NABARD Grade A previous year papers and take mock tests to assess your preparation level and identify areas for improvement.

7.1.3 English

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 English - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Word Replacement	4
Double Fillers	3
Idiom & Phrase Use	4
Coherent Paragraph	3
Words Interchanged	3
Error Detection	3
Reading Comprehension	10
Word Replacement	4
*Each question in English carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 English Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Word Replacement	1	3	NA
Double Fillers	NA	3	NA
Phrase Use	2	2	NA
Coherent Paragraph	NA	1	2
Words Interchanged	1	2	NA
Error Detection	1	2	NA
Reading Comprehension	2	8	NA

C. Key Takeaways

- The NABARD Grade A 2024 English section was **moderately difficult**.
- Reading comprehension carried the **highest weightage** and required strong reading and comprehension skills to write appropriate answers.
- **No questions** were asked from the **correct usage of words, sentence connectors, cloze test, phrase replacement, correctly spelt word, and sentence arrangement**, but you should not skip these.
- Allocate time wisely to each question, especially for Reading Comprehension, as it can be time-consuming.

7.1.4 General Awareness

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 General Awareness - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
General Awareness	6
ESI Current Affairs	2
Schemes	4
Reports	0
Banking and Finance	7
Agriculture Current Affairs	1
ESI/ARD Static	0
*Each question in GA carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 General Awareness Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
General Awareness	NA	3	2
ESI Current Affairs	1	1	NA
Schemes	1	2	1
Banking and Finance	NA	2	5
Agriculture Current Affairs	NA	1	NA

C. Key Takeways

- The NABARD Grade A 2024 General Awareness section was **difficult**.
- Many **easy questions were lengthy and time-consuming**, thus making them tough. So, students are advised to be selective while attempting the questions in the first round and then review what is left in the second round.
- **Finance questions** were asked in the GA section related to **Net Asset Value, the Scheme of RBI, and Alternate Investment funds**, which is something new.
- The majority of the questions were from **3 to 4 months old current affairs** while a few questions were from 9 to 10 months old current affairs.

- You must **prioritize the government schemes** related to rural development, agriculture, and financial inclusion.

7.1.5 Computer Knowledge

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Computer Knowledge Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Computer Hardware	2
Microsoft Office	2
Operating System	1
Abbreviation and Glossary	3
Data Communication and Computer Network	3
Introduction to Computer	1
Memory Organization	1
Miscellaneous	7
*Each question in Computer Knowledge carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 Computer Knowledge Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Computer Hardware	1	1	NA
Microsoft Office	1	1	NA
Operating System	1	NA	NA
Abbreviation and Glossary	3	NA	NA
Data Communication and Computer network	1	2	NA
Introduction to Computer	1	NA	NA
Memory Organization	1	NA	NA
Miscellaneous	NA	5	2

C. Key Takeaways

- The overall difficulty level of Computer Knowledge was **moderate**.
- Ensure a strong understanding of core concepts like **hardware components, software types, operating systems, and basic networking principles**.
- Keep an eye on advancements in technology, such as **AI, machine learning, and cybersecurity**.
- Learn and **memorize** common computer abbreviations and technical terms.

7.1.6 Decision Making

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Decision Making - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Types of Decision Making	4
Decision Making Models	1
Techniques of Decision Making	1
Bias in Decision Making	1
Miscellaneous Topics (General Management, Planning, and Leadership)	3
*Each question in Decision Making carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 Decision Making - Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Types of Decision Making	1	3	NA
Decision Making Models	1	NA	NA
Techniques of Decision Making	1	NA	NA
Bias in Decision Making	1	NA	NA
Miscellaneous Topics (General Management, Planning, and Leadership)	2	1	NA

C. Key Takeways

- The overall difficulty level of Decision Making was **moderate**.
- It is crucial to have a solid grasp of fundamental concepts like the **definition, importance, and types of decisions**.
- Familiarize yourself with the **steps involved in effective decision-making**.
- Understand the **ideal, logical approach** to decision-making.
- Familiarize yourself with different biases like confirmation bias, anchoring bias, overconfidence bias, availability bias, etc.
- Understand how the organization's culture influences decision-making.

- **Read case studies** to analyze real-world decision-making scenarios.

7.1.7 Economic & Social Issues (ESI)

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Economic and Social Issues - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
ESI Current Affairs	9
ARD Current Affairs	3
Finance	2
Schemes	14
ESI + ARD Reports	4
Union Budget	5
ESI Static	1
Agriculture Static	2
*Each question in Economic and Social Issues carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 ESI - Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
ESI Current Affairs	3	6	NA
ARD Current Affairs	NA	2	1
Finance	NA	1	1
Schemes	7	6	1
ESI + ARD Reports	1	3	NA
Union Budget	3	2	NA
ESI Static	NA	NA	1
Agriculture Static	NA	1	1

C. Key Takeaways

- The overall difficulty level of ESI was **moderate**.
- The **majority of the questions** came from schemes which were doable.
- Learn about the objectives, target groups, and implementation strategies of various government schemes related to agriculture, rural development, and financial inclusion.
- Study the impact of these schemes on rural areas and the economy as a whole.
- Should not ignore the union budget.
- Aspirants must be aware of the **recent developments** in the economy, social issues, and the agriculture sector.

7.1.8 Agriculture and Rural Development (ARD)

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 ARD - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions*
Agronomy and Field Crops	2
Agrometeorology	1
Seed and Sowing	1
Soil and Water Conservation	4
Water Resources and Irrigation Management	3
Farm and Agricultural Engineering	3
Plantations and Horticulture Crops	4
Animal Husbandry and Poultry	5
Agriculture Extension	2
Agriculture Economics	1
Ecology and Climate Change	2
Rural Development	2
ARD Current Affairs	9
*Each question in Agriculture and Rural Development carries 1 mark	

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 ARD - Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Agronomy and Field Crops	1	NA	1
Agrometeorology	NA	NA	1
Seed and Sowing	1	NA	NA
Soil and Water Conservation	2	1	1
Water Resources and Irrigation Management	NA	2	1
Farm and Agricultural Engineering	NA	1	2
Plantations and Horticulture Crops	NA	2	2
Animal Husbandry and Poultry	2	NA	3
Agriculture Extension	1	1	NA
Agriculture Economics	1	NA	NA
Ecology and Climate Change	NA	2	NA
Rural Development	2	NA	NA
ARD Current Affairs	3	5	2

C. Key Takeaways

- The majority of the questions were asked from **ARD Current Affairs**.
- A strong foundation in core agricultural concepts is crucial to solve ARD questions.
- Stay updated on the latest developments in the agriculture and rural development sector, both nationally and internationally.
- Understand the practical applications of theoretical concepts.

7.2 NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 2 Exam Analysis

The NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 2 exam was conducted on **20 October 2024**.

Based on our analysis, the overall toughness level of the NABARD Grade A 2024 Phase 2 exam was **moderate**.

7.2.1 ESI & ARD (Objective)

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 ARD (Objective) - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions
Agronomy and Field Crops	1
Cropping System and Cropping Pattern	1
Animal Husbandry and Poultry	1
Forestry	2
Agriculture Extension	1
Rural Development	1
ARD Current Affairs	8

NABARD Grade A 2024 ESI (Objective) - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions
Government Schemes	10
Reports	2
ESI Current Affairs	0
Finance Current Affairs	1
ESI Static	2

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 ARD (Objective) - Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Agronomy and Field Crops	NA	1	NA
Cropping System and Cropping Pattern	NA	1	NA
Animal Husbandry and Poultry	1	NA	NA
Forestry	NA	NA	2
Agriculture Extension	1	NA	NA
Rural Development	1	NA	NA
ARD Current Affairs	3	3	2

NABARD Grade A 2024 ESI (Objective) - Difficulty Level			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Government Schemes	1	5	4
Reports	NA	2	NA
Finance Current Affairs	NA	NA	1
ESI Static	NA	1	1

C. Key Takeways

- The majority of the questions were based on current affairs, specifically related to Rural Development.
- An equal number of questions were asked from both ESI and ARD.
- Most of the questions were **moderately difficult**, requiring a good understanding of concepts and current affairs.
- Government schemes and reports had the **highest weightage** and were of moderate difficulty. So, you should prioritize them.
- While not as dominant as in the Agriculture and Rural Development section, current affairs, especially in Finance, were still important.
- Stay updated on the latest developments in the agriculture, rural development, economy, and social sectors.

- Thoroughly understand the objectives, implementation, and impact of key government initiatives.
- Build a solid foundation in agricultural and economic principles.

7.2.2 ESI & ARD (Objective)

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 ESI & ARD (Descriptive) - Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	Questions
Plantations and Horticulture Crops	1
Indian Agriculture	1
Farming Systems	1
Farm and Agricultural Engineering	1
Financial Inclusion	1
Government Schemes	1

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 ESI & ARD Difficulty Level (Descriptive)			
Topic	Easy	Moderate	Difficult
Plantations and Horticulture Crops	NA	1	NA
Indian Agriculture	NA	1	NA
Farming Systems	1	NA	NA
Farm and Agricultural Engineering	NA	1	NA
Financial Inclusion	NA	1	NA
Government Schemes	NA	1	NA

C. Key Takeways

- The overall difficulty level of the questions was **moderate**, with a focus on understanding core concepts and their practical applications.
- Knowledge of **recent developments** in the agricultural and rural development sectors was crucial for answering questions effectively.
- Regularly practice writing answers to express your ideas on the current ESI and ARD topics.

- Use facts and figures to make your answers more impactful.

7.2.3 Descriptive English

A. Topic-Wise Weightage

NABARD Grade A 2024 Descriptive English - Topic-Wise Weightage		
Topic	Questions	Marks
Essay	1 topic to be chosen out of 4	40
Precis	1	30
Letter	3	30
Total	5	100

B. Difficulty Level

NABARD Grade A 2024 Descriptive English - Difficulty Level	
Topic	Difficulty Level
Essay	Moderate
Precis	Moderate
Letter	Moderate

C. Key Takeways

- The exam included a letter instead of reading comprehension. Hence, you should practice both letter and RC for the next exam.
- 4 essays were asked in a similar pattern as the previous year, but the **word limit** for the essay was **250 to 270 words**, which could have been a challenge for the aspirants as last year the word limit was 500 to 550.
- Precis and comprehension passages were **moderately easy to solve**, and with the practice

Part 8

NABARD Grade A

Preparation

Preparation

Understanding what to focus on is important, but picking the right study resources can take your preparation to the next level.

8.1 Resources for Each Subject

Below are the best books and resources for NABARD Grade A preparation.

- **Quantitative Aptitude Books for NABARD Grade A**
 - Quantitative Aptitude for Competitive Examinations (First 9 Chapters) *by R.S. Agarwal*
- **Reasoning Ability Books for NABARD Grade A**
 - A Modern Approach to Verbal and Non-Verbal Reasoning *by R.S. Agarwal*
- **English Books for NABARD Grade A**
 - English Grammar & Composition *by Wren & Martin*
- **Computer Awareness for NABARD Grade A**
 - Computer Awareness *by Arihant*
- **Decision Making for NABARD Grade A**
 - Principles & Practices of Management *by TN Chhabra*
- **ESI (Static) for NABARD Grade A**
 - Indian Economy *by Ramesh Singh*
 - Introductory Macroeconomics *12th NCERT*
 - Social Problems in India *by Ram Ahuja*
- **ESI (Current) for NABARD Grade A**
 - Press Information Bureau (PIB)
 - The Hindu
- **ARD (Static) for NABARD Grade A**
 - Fundamentals of Agriculture (Part 1 + 2) *by Arun Katyayan*
 - Agriculture at a Glance *by RK Sharma*
 - Competitive Book for Agriculture *by Nem Raj Sunda*
 - A Textbook of Animal Husbandry *by GC Banerjee*
 - Handbook of Fisheries *by ICAR*
 - Elements of Agricultural Engineering *by Dr Jagadeeshwar Sahay*
- **General Awareness for NABARD Grade A**
 - Economic Times
 - Live Mint
 - Press Information Bureau (PIB)

Important Note: As the syllabus of the SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Paper 2 and Phase 2 Paper 2 is **the same**, so are the books and resources. So, you can refer to the above-mentioned list for the books and resources for both Phase 1 Paper 2 and Phase 2 Paper 2.

All the above resources are not to be read cover to cover. You must refer to the syllabus as well as the previous year's questions and then do the selective reading.

8.2 Resources for Interview Preparation

If you have read the pattern of SEBI, then you would be aware that the weightage of the interview is 15%, which indicates the interview is going to be more about your analytical skill and your perception about the external world.

So, these are the 7 key areas you need to focus on for the interview.

8.2.1 Detailed Application Form (DAF):

DAF is the most important tool for your interview because it tells the panel members about you and helps them judge you.

If you have prepared at least 100 questions on your DAF including family background, educational qualification, gap years if any, low % in academics, etc. really well, you will be very easily able to turn the interview in your favour.

Also, while filling your DAF, you should avoid some of these common mistakes -

- Always **give professional references** so that they can vouch for your competitiveness and intelligence.
- Following a random order for filling educational qualifications
- Not giving honest reasons for leaving the previous job. You need to be honest yet careful while filling this section, as in you may write that for better career prospects you left the job but saying that you left the job because your boss was pathetic can do harm.

8.2.2 Mannerism in Interview:

Knowledge is important, but your personality plays a vital role in creating your impression. Mannerism includes -

1. Dress Code
2. How to Enter & Exit the room
3. How to make optimal eye contact
4. Right Body Language for Interview
5. Right Sitting Posture for Interview
6. Right Hand Movement during Interview
7. How to handle stress
8. How to say 'I Don't Know' to a Question?
9. How to politely disagree if at all you need to disagree

8.2.3 Mock Interview:

Mock interview helps you test yourself. It stimulates your thought process.

For e.g., the questions asked in the mock interview may be on different lines which you might have not even thought of.

It gives you firsthand experience, but only if you take a mock interview with an experienced panellist.

8.3 NABARD Grade A 300-Hour Study Plan

This plan is in hours so **you** decide how many days or months each subject will take. Multiply daily hours × days to reach the subject total.

You can fit 300 hours into 60 days (5 hrs/day), 90 days (3.3 hrs/day), or any timeline you prefer. Keep ~20 extra days as buffer for revision, mocks, or slips.

NABARD Grade A 300 Hours Study Plan	
Subject / Area	Hours
ARD Static – Core 8–10 chapters	70
ARD Static – Remaining + peripheral topics	20
ARD Current Affairs	25
ESI Current Affairs	45
ESI Static (basics only)	15
General Awareness (incl. random GA)	20
Finance (Static + Finance CA for GA)	20
Quantitative Aptitude (selective)	20
Reasoning (selective, safe topics)	20
English	10
Computer Awareness + Decision Making	10
Descriptive Answer Writing (ESI + ARD)	10
Full Revision + Mock Test Analysis	15
Total	300

8.4 NABARD Subject-Wise Strategy

8.4.1 ARD Static - Core Syllabus Chapters

- Agronomy & Field Crops
- Farming Systems
- Soil & Water Conservation
- Plantation & Horticulture Crops
- Animal Husbandry & Poultry
- Fisheries
- Forestry
- Agriculture Extension
- Irrigation
- Seeds & Sowing

Highest priority because 20–25 questions come from here

How to study:

- Focus on **concept clarity + one-liner facts** (definitions, classification, key terms).
- Make **short summary sheets** for each chapter.
- Practice **MCQs chapter-wise**; mark tricky ones and revise.
- Because Phase 1 ARD is ~30–32 marks static, your goal is to make these chapters **near-perfect**.

8.4.2 ARD Static – Peripheral & Non-conventional (20 hours)

- Paper now asks from **non-conventional chapters** and **peripheral topics**, e.g.:
 - Environment & Ecology (IUCN categories, artificial ecosystem etc)
 - Basic genetics/plant breeding-type facts (e.g., gene causing seedlessness)
 - Animal diseases, milking-related terms (even if not clearly written in syllabus)
 - Agriculture Engineering numericals (irrigation, pumps, field capacity etc)

What to do:

- After finishing core 10 chapters, cover:
 - Environment & Ecology basics (NCERT-level).
 - Important **animal diseases + dairy/milking basics**.
 - Selected numericals from **Agricultural Engineering**.
- Focus on **simple, NCERT-type questions**; many from such chapters are easy but ignored by students.

Goal: you shouldn't "leave whole chapters blank" – at least cover the most obvious concepts once.

8.4.3 ARD Current Affairs

- Phase 1 ARD CA ≈ 8–10 marks.
- Phase 2 ARD objective: **1:1 ratio** – about 7 static + 8 ARD CA questions.
- So ARD CA is **non-negotiable**.

Coverage (Adapt months to your exam month):

- Focus on the **last 3–5 months** as "must-do", then previous 2 months if time.
- Priority inside ARD Current Affairs:
 - Agriculture-related **government schemes** (subsidies, insurance, credit, irrigation, seeds, PMFBY, etc.)
 - Important **reports & data** related to agriculture, rural development, NABARD, RBI, IARI etc.
 - Major launches in seeds, varieties, and technologies **only if they had decent news coverage** – don't try to read random annual reports.

How to study:

- Maintain a **separate ARD CA notebook** (scheme name, ministry, key features, targets, year).
- Revise same notes **multiple times** – depth matters more than width.

8.4.4 ESI Current Affairs

- Out of 40 questions in ESI:
 - **Majority (30+ questions)** from **current affairs + schemes**.
 - Very few from static.

Priority order (ESI part):

1. **Government schemes (ESI-related)** – poverty, employment, social security, health, education, financial inclusion, etc.
2. **ESI Current Affairs (general economic news)** –
 - Inflation data & trends
 - GDP / growth projections
 - Unemployment, poverty stats
 - Reports & indices related to economy & social sector
3. **Agriculture Current Affairs overlap** (where relevant to ESI topics).

How to study:

- Make separate notes for:
 - **Schemes** (ministry, launch year, objective, key features, important numbers).
 - **Economic news** (who released which report, what % growth, inflation types, forecasts etc.)
- Revise using **MCQs + tabular notes**.

8.4.5 ESI Static

- ESI static weight is **small** (4–5 questions).
- Only go deep if your economics basics are weak.

Key topics:

- Monetary Policy (repo, reverse repo, policy tools).
- Fiscal Policy (tax, deficit, FRBM idea).
- Inflation (types, causes, effects, CPI vs WPI).
- Poverty, unemployment – basic concepts and measures.
- National Income concepts – GDP, GNP, NNP, etc.
- Budget basics.
- National & international financial institutions (IMF, World Bank, ADB, RBI etc. – only basics).

8.4.6 General Awareness + Finance

General Awareness

- GA is becoming **random**, with obscure questions (e.g., variety name from an annual report, detailed rank of an airforce station).
- Aim for **5–7 marks** in General Awareness. Anything extra is bonus.
- This keeps your mind calm even if paper looks crazy.

Priority within General Awareness

1. One-liner current affairs (national + international) – important summits, appointments, rankings, important days.
2. Static bits linked to recent news.
3. Defence, places-in-news, organisations etc.

Finance (Static + Current)

Big change from 2024:

- Out of 20 General Awareness questions, **7–8 were from Finance** (static + current).
- Questions on:

- Certificates of Deposit, money market instruments.
- Regulations like **minimum Net Owned Funds required** for certain entities.
- Banking & forex related facts.

What to cover:

- Basics of:
 - Money market & capital market instruments.
 - Basic banking terms (CD, CP, RTGS/NEFT, types of accounts).
 - RBI regulations in broad sense (just common ones).
- Finance Current Affairs (last 3–5 months):
 - Important RBI notifications, monetary policy highlights.
 - Major changes in regulations relevant to markets / forex / NBFCs, etc.

Rule: once **ARD + ESI + schemes** are covered, then invest these hours in Finance.

8.4.7 Non-Merit Section

Remember: **Phase 1 merit is only GA + ESI + ARD**. For non-merit sections, you just need to **clear the sectional cut-off**.

- Check **PYQ / mock first**.
- If your sectional cut-off is already clearing comfortably, **don't waste time** here.
- If not, prepare **only high-yield topics**.

1. Quantitative Aptitude

Highest priority topics:

- Percentages
- Simplification / Approximation
- Number Series
- Quadratic Equations
- Data Interpretation (table, bar, pie, line – basic % + ratio)

If time remains, add:

- Profit & Loss
- Ratio & Proportion
- Simple & Compound Interest
- Time & Work
- Time, Speed & Distance

Goal:

- Keep a **target score = highest historical cutoff + 2–3 marks** (e.g., if cutoff ≈ 5 , target $\approx 7-8$).
- Enough to be safe, no need to chase 20/20.

2. Reasoning

- Puzzles/arrangements are most scoring but **time-consuming & risky**.
- For safety, first solidify **short questions**.

Priority topics (safe + fast):

- Alpha-numeric series

- Coding–Decoding
- Syllogism (even if not asked one year, it can reappear)
- Ranking / Ordering
- Blood Relations
- Machine Input–Output

After these, **add 1–2 standard puzzle types** you are comfortable with.

Target: same logic – **cutoff + 2–3 marks**.

3. English

Most important areas:

- Reading Comprehension (RC)
- Error Detection / Spotting
- Sentence rearrangement
- Word rearrangement / fill in the blanks

Focus on:

- Daily reading (editorials/basic articles).
- Practising **previous year-type RCs and error questions**.

4. Computer Awareness + Decision Making

Cover in Computer Awareness:

- Basics of computers & generations
- Hardware & memory
- Software & Operating Systems
- MS Office basics
- Database basics
- Internet, networking, cyber security basics
- Common keyboard shortcuts

Cover in Decision Making:

- Basics & importance of decision making
- Types of decisions
- Decision-making models & approaches
- Factors affecting decisions
- Types of problems in decision making

Here questions are usually **theory + basic logic**; read once, revise twice.

8.4.8 Descriptive Answer Writing

- Learn **answer structures** (Intro–Body–Conclusion, way forward, data usage).
- Prepare **model points** for common themes:
 - Inflation, growth, poverty, unemployment
 - Agriculture productivity, irrigation, climate change, credit, FPOs
 - Government schemes – impact analysis
- Practise writing **8–10 full answers** under time limit and word limit.

What Next?

This guidebook has equipped you with the essential information that can help you understand the NABARD Grade A exam and how to crack it. Here are some tips that can further help in your exam preparation.

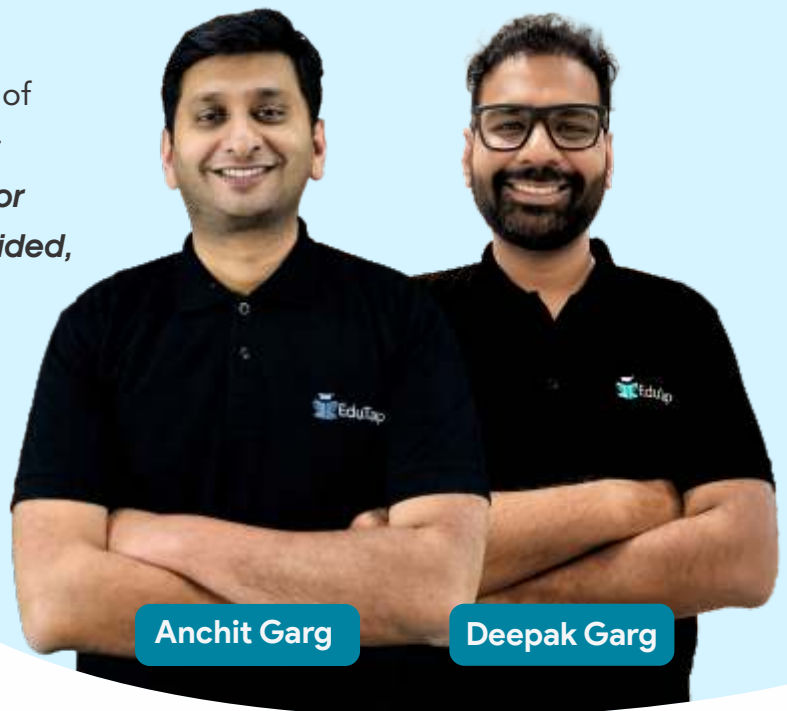
- **Analyze Previous Year Papers:** Analyze the PYQ papers to understand the exam trends and the type of questions asked. Failing to do so might leave you unprepared for the diversity of questions that could be posed during the exam, putting you at a disadvantage.
- **Practice Mock Tests:** Regularly practice mock tests to simulate exam conditions. This helps improve time management, accuracy, and familiarity with the exam format. Without regular simulation of exam conditions, you may encounter challenges in managing your time effectively during the actual exam.
- **Focus on Weak Areas:** Solving mock tests and analyzing PYQs help you identify your strengths and weaknesses. Now you can allocate more time to strengthen your weak areas. Regularly assess your progress and adapt your study plan accordingly.
- **Supplement Your Resources:** Do not stick to only one resource for preparation. It is recommended to always supplement your preparation with additional resources for overall preparation. However, do not go overboard with it.
- **Make Notes:** Take detailed notes summarizing key points, essential concepts, and important facts to ensure retention. This will serve as a quick reference during revision.
- **Stay Positive and Motivated:** Maintain a positive mindset throughout your preparation. Surround yourself with supportive individuals and believe in your ability to succeed.

By following these recommendations and leveraging the resources provided in this guidebook, you can significantly enhance your chances of becoming a NABARD officer. Remember, the key is to stay focused, committed, and persistent on your path to success.

We at EduTap wish you the very best in your NABARD Grade A Exam preparation.

About Us

We are a passionate team of experienced professionals who understand the challenges of aspirants preparing for government jobs. Our vision is to *"create a nurturing ecosystem for the aspirants so that they can feel safe, guided, and mentored."*



Anchit Garg

Deepak Garg

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At EduTap, our mission is to empower students to reach their full potential by providing comprehensive guidance, expert mentorship, and a supportive community. Since our start in 2016, we've grown into a trusted platform for aspirants, delivering exceptional results in government recruitment exams and certifications year after year.

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